RESEARCH IN SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGICAL EDUCATION

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NEW ARTICLE

Teaching science to students with learning disabilities: teacher and student views on the food unit

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WHAT DID THE RESEARCHERS INVESTIGATE?

- Students with learning disabilities may have difficulty understanding abstract scientific concepts and terminology and relating them to everyday life.
- The study explores teachers' and students' views on the Grade 4 Food unit, using an embedded single-case design.
- Data came from semi-structured interviews with 10 teachers and 10 students and document analysis.

Pürsün and Türkoğlu Boyvat (2026) · Research in Science & Technological Education · doi.org/10.1080/02635143.2026.2743248

WHAT DID THEY FIND?

- Students learned about foods within the food groups they encountered in everyday life.
- They showed conceptual deficiencies in relating nutrients to everyday foods and struggled with science terminology.
- Despite teachers' reported use of everyday examples, students still struggled to link them to scientific concepts.
- Teachers' use of instructional adaptations showed deficiencies.

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